



Medford School Committee

Medford, Massachusetts 02155

MEMORANDUM & AGENDA

TO: School Committee Members

FROM: Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent

POSTING DATE: Monday, February 26, 2024

MEETING DATE: **Wednesday, February 28, 2024**

RE: **SPECIAL MEETING OF THE SCHOOL COMMITTEE -
Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA) Committee**

Please be advised that on **Wednesday, February 28, 2024 at 5:00 p.m.** there will be a Committee of the Whole Meeting, to be held remotely via zoom.

The meeting can be viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast and Verizon. Participants can log or call in by using the following link or call-in number:

Join Zoom Meeting

Medford Public Schools invites you to a meeting with a remote participation option.		
Virtual Link	https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/92843377810	
Meeting ID	928 4337 7810	
Dial by Location	https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/u/addnawmLgY	

Questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing:
medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us

Those submitting questions or comments must include the following information:

1. Your first and last name
2. Your Medford street address
1. Your question or comment

AGENDA

As approved by the School Committee on February 5, 2024, this meeting is to discuss the forming of a committee for the Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA) process.

2024-10 Offered by Member Graham, Member Ruseau and Member Reinfeld
Resolution on the Medford Comprehensive High School Building Committee

Whereas the Massachusetts School Building Authority, herein 'MSBA' or 'the Authority', has invited Medford High School into the Eligibility Phase of the School Building process; and whereas, the Medford School Committee must form a School Building Committee that complies with CMR 963 2.00

(<https://www.mass.gov/regulations/963-CMR-200-school-building-grant-program>)

which reads:

School Building Committee.

- A. The Eligible Applicant shall formulate a school building committee for the purpose of generally monitoring the Application process and to advise the Eligible Applicant during the construction of an Approved Project.
- B. The school building committee shall be formed in accordance with the provisions of the Eligible Applicant's local charter and/or by-laws and it is recommended that the city, town, regional school district, or independent agricultural and technical school make a reasonable effort to include one or more of the following individuals:
 - a. the local chief executive officer of the Eligible Applicant, or, in the case of a town whose local chief executive officer is a multi-party body, said body may elect one of its members to serve on the school building committee;

- b. the town administrator, town manager, or city manager, where applicable;
 - c. at least one member of the school committee, as required by M.G.L. c. 71, § 68;
 - d. the superintendent of schools;
 - e. the local official responsible for building maintenance;
 - f. a representative of the office or body authorized by law to construct school buildings in that city, town or regional school district, or for that independent agricultural and technical school;
 - g. the school principal from the subject school;
 - h. a member who has knowledge of the educational mission and function of the facility;
 - i. a local budget official or member of the local finance committee;
 - j. members of the community with architecture, engineering and/or construction experience to provide advice relative to the effect of the Proposed Project on the community and to examine building design and construction in terms of its constructability.
- C. The Authority may hold “best practices” information sessions at varying geographic locations in the Commonwealth for the purposes of keeping school building committees up to date on regulatory and policy activities of the Authority.
- D. The Eligible Applicant shall submit to the Authority for its approval, a written statement describing the composition of the school building committee and the role of the school building committee in monitoring the Application process and advising the Eligible Applicant during the construction of the Approved Project. The written statement shall be in a format prescribed by the Authority.
- E. The Authority shall approve the composition and role of the school building committee which approval shall not be unreasonably withheld. The Authority’s approval will be based on several factors, including, but not limited to:
- a. past performance of the school building committee, the building committee, whether temporary or permanent, or any other committee responsible for the oversight, management, or administration of the construction of public buildings, the composition of the school building committee and qualifications of its individual members, the powers and duties of the school building committee; and the school building committee’s procedures for conducting its meetings; and

- b. the extent to which there is representation of the municipal government, school district personnel with management, educational and maintenance expertise, and representation of members of the local community with design and construction experience. After the approval of the school building committee by the Authority, if any, the Eligible Applicant shall notify the Authority in writing within 20 calendar days of any changes to the membership or the duties of said committee. The Eligible Applicant shall make a reasonable effort to ensure the continuity of membership of the school building committee throughout the life of an Approved Project.

and;

Whereas the Medford School Committee seeks to establish a diverse, representative, and skilled Building Committee that complies with all of the rules and regulations set forth by the MSBA; and

Whereas the Medford School Committee has ambitious goals to move quickly, seamlessly, and comprehensively through the prescribed School Building process with the following goals:

1. Plan comprehensively for all programming currently residing on the Medford High School Campus including vocational and non-vocational 9-12 education, 9-12 athletics, Medford Family Network, Medford Community Schools programming, early childhood education including but not limited to the Medford Early Education Program (MEEP) and Kids Corner;
2. Consider whether placement of the Curtis Tufts Alternative High School on the MHS campus will provide increased educational opportunities to enrolled students;
3. Ensure robust public input and stakeholder feedback at appropriate milestones throughout the project;
4. Listen to educator and administrator input regarding the future of educational best practices and plans for the students of Medford;
5. Create plans for a building that advances Medford's climate goals and achieves LEED v5 certification to meet the Paris Climate Accord's 2030 and 2050 targets; and
6. Moves efficiently and effectively through the building process in a manner that ensures students are able to learn in the 'new' building as quickly as is feasible.

Now, therefore, be it:

Resolved, that the Medford School Committee:

- 1) establishes the 'Medford Comprehensive High School Building Committee', said committee may be referred to as the 'School Building Committee';
- 2) acknowledges the significant investment members of the committee are making in the future of the City of Medford and Medford Public Schools and regrets that the positions can not be compensated in compliance with MSBA rules and regulations;
- 3) grants the authority to the School Building Committee Chair to:
 - a) recommend extensions of member terms; subject to approval by the Medford School Committee;
 - b) recommend replacement of non-participatory members; subject to approval by the Medford School Committee;
 - c) work with the appointed committee to maintain various subcommittees, including but not limited to:
 - i) Communication and Community Engagement
 - ii) Sustainability, Mechanical, Electrical, Plumbing
 - iii) Finance
 - iv) Other committees as established by the chair;
 - d) work with the appointed committee to convene external advisory committees/consultancy on an as-needed basis
 - e) provide monthly updates to the Medford School Committee; and
 - f) act in accordance with MSBA-established rules, regulations, and requirements on behalf of the School Building Committee.
- 4) requires a report be presented to the Medford School Committee regarding the School Building Committee's governing structure, scope, resources, community engagement plans, website and document management plans, and training completed no later than May 20, 2024;
- 5) establishes the initial term of members beginning April 15, 2024 (the start of Medford's Eligibility Phase is May 1, 2024) and ending January 26, 2025 (270 days) or the successful completion of the eligibility phase, whichever is sooner. The School Committee desires stability in the committee and will extend member terms throughout each phase of the process at the recommendation of the Chair;
- 6) requires the School Building Committee to comply with MSBA guidelines and align with (but is not bound by) Medford School Committee policy BDF, Advisory Committees to the School Committee;
- 7) defines the membership of the School Building Committee as:
 - a) no more than 15 voting members;
 - b) appoints the following individuals to the committee:
 - i) voting Members:
 - (1) Jenny Graham, Committee Chair;

- (2) Breanna Lungo Koehn, Mayor (Administrators, Local CEO, Representative of Office Authorized by Law to Construct School Buildings);
 - (3) Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent of Schools;
 - (4) Suzanne Galusi, Assistant Superintendent Curriculum and Instructions;
 - (5) Peter Cushing, Assistant Superintendent Enrichment and Innovation (Local Official Responsible for Building Maintenance); and
 - (6) Marta Cabral (School Principal, Member Knowledgeable in Educational Mission and Function of the Facility).
- ii) non-voting members
 - (1) Bob Dickinson (Local Budget Official);
 - (2) To be determined (Massachusetts Certified Public Purchasing Official);
 - (3) Chad Fallon, Director Medford Vocational School (School Principal, Member Knowledgeable in Educational Mission and Function of the Facility);
 - (4) Joan Bowen, Director of Pupil Services (Member Knowledgeable in Educational Mission and Function of the Facility);
 - (5) John McLaughlin, Director of Buildings and Grounds; and
 - (6) Thomas Dalton, Director of Communications;
- c) solicits applications for interested members of the Medford School Committee and the Medford City Council:
 - i) voting Members:
 - (1) one School Committee member; and
 - (2) one City Councilor;
- d) solicits applications for interested Medford residents to fill 7 additional open positions on the committee as voting members. Medford Public School teachers and staff who are Medford residents are welcome to apply.
- 8) directs the Superintendent to create an application form for membership in the Building Committee by 5 pm, Friday, March 8, 2024, and
 - a) the form will include at least the following elements for the applicant to complete:
 - i) Full name (required);
 - ii) Full address (required);
 - iii) Contact information (required);
 - iv) Why do you want to be on this Building committee (in 200 words or less)? (required);

- v) Are you related to a current Medford School Committee Member, and if so, how? (required);
- vi) Will you require an interpreter? (required);
- vii) Do you have access to a computer and an internet connection to participate in Zoom meetings? (if the answer is 'no,' we can provide you with the technology) (required);
- viii) Are you a teacher or staff member at Medford High School? (required);
- ix) Do you have experience in school building projects (architecture, design, engineering, and/or other construction?) (required). If so, please explain;
- x) Do you have experience in large program communications and/or management? If so, please explain; (required)
- xi) What other relevant expertise or unique perspective do you bring to the process? (optional)
- xii) Are you a Medford Public Schools student? (required);
- xiii) Are you a caregiver of a Medford Public Schools student? If so, please list grade(s) and school(s). (required);
- xiv) Can you commit to a minimum of twice monthly committee/subcommittee meetings held on Monday evenings for approximately 2 hours beginning at 6 pm and held in person? (required);
- xv) Can you commit to participation through the entire eligibility phase of the project which may extend through January 26, 2025? (required);
- xvi) Are you willing and able to commit to this appointment through the entire life of the project, which may last up to 7 years? (required);
- xvii) Will you actively support and participate in a public campaign to secure funding from Medford's taxpayers to pay for aspects of the project not directly supported by MSBA? (required);
- xviii) Demographics information including (optional):
 - (1) age category;
 - (2) gender identity;
 - (3) sexual orientation;
 - (4) household income;
 - (5) educational attainment;
 - (6) what language you mainly speak at home;
 - (7) racial/ethnic identity; and
 - (8) disability status
- xix) Are you a registered voter? (required)
 - (1) If yes, Please indicate your voting Ward and Precinct (optional);

- b) the application form will be posted on the Medford Public Schools website and communicated through the usual mechanisms the district uses, including translations to predominant languages on Friday, March 8, 2024;
- c) the application form will open on Friday, March 8, 2024, and close on Tuesday, March 26, 2024;
- d) valid applications must meet all requirements:
 - i) submitted within the application period;
 - ii) the applicant must be a current resident of Medford, Massachusetts;
 - iii) the applicant cannot be a close relative of a current Medford School Committee Member, i.e., children, parents, siblings, or the spouses of children, parents, or siblings;
- e) all required elements of the application have been completed;
- 9) directs the School Building Committee Chair, Mayor, and Superintendent to review applications and provide a recommendation to the Medford School Committee for the appointment of one Medford City Councilor, one Medford School Committee member, and seven community members no later than April 8, 2024; further directs that the Superintendent will provide all valid applications to members of the Medford School Committee upon request;
- 10) directs the School Building Committee Chair, Mayor, and Superintendent to recommend a Vice Chair of the School Building Committee no later than April 8, 2024;
- 11) directs the Superintendent to announce the School Building Committee on the district and project website no later than one week following the approval of the School Building Committee membership by the Medford School Committee; and
- 12) directs the School Building Committee to hold its first meeting no later than May 1, 2024. All meetings are public meetings and will be conducted in accordance with the Open Meeting Law using Robert's Rules of Order.